Korea University

Strategic Development Plan

Free Intelligence, a New Era

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I. Message from the Candidate

FINE - KU
Free Intelligence, a New Era



Dear Members of the Korea University Community,

I am Byung-Hyun Yoo, a candidate for the 22nd President of Korea University.

Where is Korea University heading today? Will the university we have always cherished and taken pride in remain a source of pride for future generations?

Together, we have endured difficult times, including a prolonged tuition freeze and the COVID-19 pandemic. Yet, before we have had time to recover, we find ourselves in the midst of an even greater transformation brought about by artificial intelligence. In an age when AI can provide answers to countless questions, we must reconsider the very purpose of a university. What should we research, how should we teach, and what kind of people should we educate?

I believe the answer lies in **free intelligence**. Machines are now better at finding predetermined answers quickly. What universities must preserve and cultivate is the ability to ask new questions, critically examine given answers, and use technology responsibly for the benefit of humanity and society. These abilities flourish when researchers are free to determine the direction of their research, students can take charge of their own learning, and every member of the university community is respected. We must ask ourselves whether our university provides sufficient autonomy and respect.

I have spent my academic career teaching and researching law. I have also served the university for approximately six years in several administrative positions, including Vice President for Planning and Budget, Director of the Audit Office, Vice President for External Affairs, and Director of Fundraising Planning. These experiences allowed me to see, from both faculty and administrative perspectives, the obstacles that researchers face and the difficulties that hinder university administration. I also helped launch the KU PRIDE CLUB, a small-donation program that brought together more than 5,000 alumni in Korea and abroad. This experience strengthened my conviction that **the true strength of Korea University lies in its people**.

I propose three guiding principles for the future of our university: **Be Ourselves, Thrive Together, and Soar Higher.**

"Be Ourselves" means restoring the fundamental mission of the university. Rather than pursuing external recognition and rankings, we will focus on our core missions of education and research. I will introduce basic research funding available to all full-time faculty members without conditions and gradually establish research funds of KRW 100 million per faculty member through each college and school. The university will take responsibility for providing the basic resources for research, while researchers themselves will determine its direction.

"Thrive Together" means embracing diversity in harmony. I will build a university where different academic disciplines and members of our community are recognized and valued. We will move away from the practice of having the central administration make all important decisions and establish a more autonomous system centered on departments, colleges, and schools. We will listen carefully to those affected by university policies and make decisions together.

"Soar Higher" means moving beyond our limitations. I will ensure that innovative initiatives are not held back by budget constraints, institutional barriers, or outdated practices. Korea University will take a leading role in shaping the future of higher education in Korea in the age of AI. To support this transformation, I will introduce a new paradigm of fundraising, expanding its focus beyond traditional scholarships and campus construction to research, education, and administrative innovation.

To our faculty, I promise an environment where you can devote yourselves fully to research and teaching. To our staff, I promise a workplace where your expertise is respected and meaningful opportunities for professional growth are available. To our students, I promise a campus where you can learn and pursue your ambitions without being burdened by everyday concerns. Together with the members of our Sejong Campus and Korea University Medical Center, I will build a university that brings together our distinctive strengths and moves forward as one.

I will be a president who leads with dedication and respect.

When difficult tasks arise, I will be the first to step forward. When we share the rewards of our achievements, I will put the members of our university community first. I will listen with an open mind, but once a decision has been made, I will carry it through with determination. Rather than being swayed by immediate recognition or approval, I will look ahead to the Korea University of 10 years, and even 50 years, from now.

In this period of profound change in higher education, Korea University will repeatedly face critical decisions that shape its future. Each sound decision made by the president will

serve as a guidepost for the university's future. Drawing on my years of experience in education, research, and university administration, and bringing together the wisdom of the Korea University community, I will develop bold solutions that turn challenges into opportunities, even in the face of the greatest difficulties. I will take full responsibility for seeing them through.

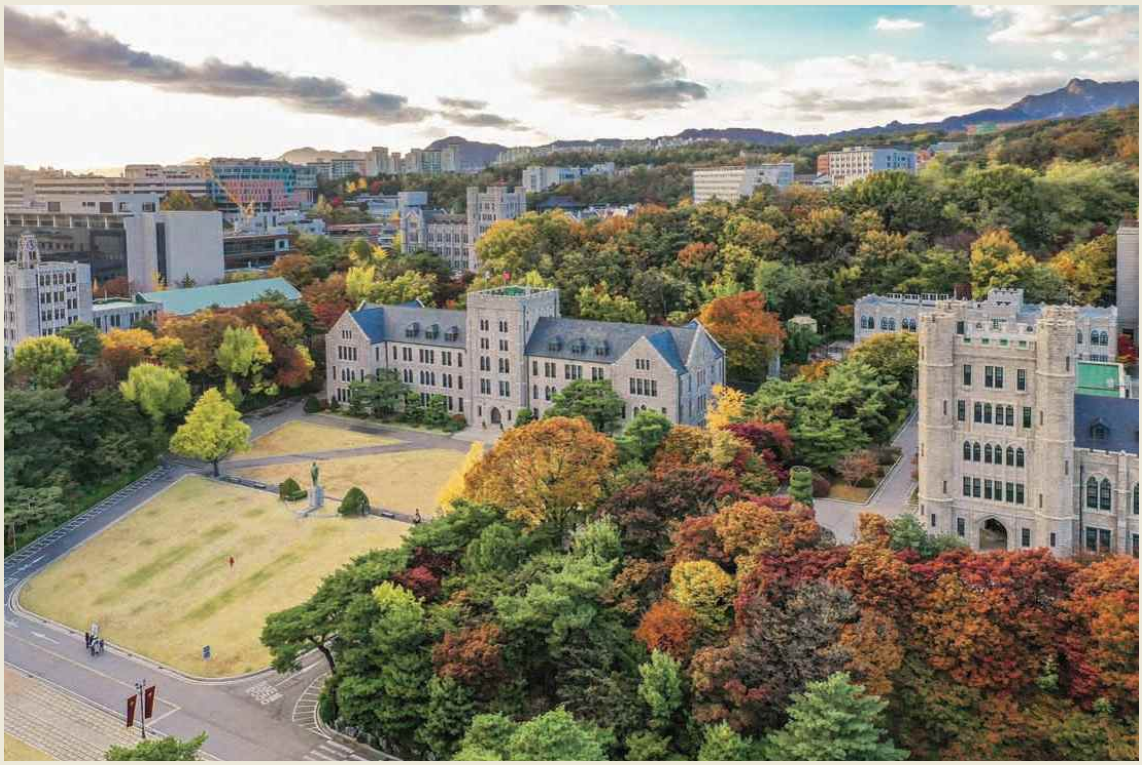
Dear Members of the Korea University Community,

If I am entrusted with the responsibility of serving our university, I will always uphold the spirit of placing the public interest before personal interests, as emphasized by our founder, Inchon. I will bring together the dedication and passion of every member of our community. Together, we will build a university that future generations can take even greater pride in—a Korea University that, in the words of our university song, will **"shine forever."**

Thank you.

October 31, 2026

Byung-Hyun Yoo
Candidate for the 22nd President of Korea University



II. Six Commitments from the Candidate

Byung-Hyun Yoo
Leadership with Dedication and Respect

I make the following six commitments to the Korea University community.

1. I will establish research funds to support ambitious and creative research.

1. Shift the focus of fundraising from scholarships and campus construction toward research funding.
2. Aim to establish research funds of KRW 100 million per full-time faculty member, based on approximately 1,800 faculty members.
3. Establish a researcher-centered system that allows individual colleges and schools to manage and allocate research funds autonomously.

2. I will strengthen university education in the age of AI while remaining true to its fundamental mission.

1. Support creative and original approaches to education using AI.
2. Strengthen education that develops critical thinking and sound judgment, in keeping with the university's fundamental mission.
3. Expand education that cultivates free intelligence, problem-solving abilities, and a commitment to contributing to society.

3. I will create a campus where students can learn and live in ways that meet their needs and aspirations.

1. Establish student-centered advising and support systems that enable students to design their own academic paths.
2. Shift the scholarship paradigm beyond tuition assistance to include financial support for living expenses.
3. Improve student housing to enhance well-being and safety, including expanding single-occupancy dormitory rooms and introducing a housing certification system.

4. I will create a workplace where staff can develop their expertise and find fulfillment in their work.

1. Establish an Administrative Capacity Task Force to strengthen accountability and develop a more effective and stable administrative system.
2. Enhance staff expertise through systematic and continuous training and expand flexible

working arrangements that support work-life balance.
3. Foster a cooperative labor-management culture based on mutual trust and respect.

5. I will elevate Korea University's global reputation and standing.

1. Strengthen global partnerships with leading universities, businesses, and international organizations.
2. Enhance the reputation of Korea University Medical Center by developing the distinctive strengths of its three affiliated hospitals.
3. Create synergies by integrating international exchange programs for outgoing and incoming students and scholars.

6. I will build a university that contributes to society and leads the academic community.

1. Strengthen the university's social responsibility (USR) and its commitment to the public good.
2. Expand Korea University's substantive contributions to the nation and society in keeping with its standing as one of Korea's leading universities.
3. Establish a standard of excellence and leadership that inspires pride among Korea University alumni around the world.



III. Questions for the Candidate

Q1. What does Korea University need most at this time?

I believe Korea University's most urgent priority is to substantially strengthen its research competitiveness and establish a virtuous cycle in which outstanding research leads to improvements in the quality of education.

A university's competitiveness ultimately comes from its research and education. A university becomes stronger when excellent research generates new knowledge and its findings enrich students' learning. To achieve this, I will pursue a range of policies that enable researchers to conduct their work in a stable environment while taking on new challenges.

1. I will establish research endowment funds and introduce basic research funding.

The university should take responsibility for providing the basic resources for research, while researchers themselves determine its direction. I will establish a foundation that enables all faculty members to conduct research with stability and develop an autonomous research support system suited to the characteristics of each academic discipline.

- Gradually establish research endowment funds for individual colleges and schools, targeting KRW 100 million per full-time faculty member.
- Introduce basic research funding that faculty members can use without conditions, rather than as a reward for research performance.
- Allow colleges and schools to manage their research funds autonomously according to their academic characteristics.

2. I will create an environment where researchers can focus on their research.

- Promote the construction of new research buildings and secure stable research space.
- Establish a Global Academic Exchange Fund and expand support for international academic activities.
- Expand support for publication fees in leading domestic and international academic journals.
- Simplify research administration procedures and strengthen professional research support staff.

3. I will nurture outstanding researchers and support ambitious research.

- Strengthen support systems for early-career researchers and the next generation of scholars.

- Recruit world-renowned scholars and improve faculty recruitment procedures.
- Launch the KU Grand Challenge Interdisciplinary Research Program.
- Expand the International Collaborative Research Seed Fund and support large-scale global research projects.
- Expand AI-based research infrastructure and introduce KU AI-RG.

I will build a Korea University that provides a strong foundation for research, creates greater opportunities for outstanding scholarship, and translates research achievements into educational advancement. I believe that strengthening our fundamental academic competitiveness is the surest path toward becoming a world-leading university.

Related Commitments

- [1-1] Establishment of College-Level Research Funds and Basic Research Funding
- [1-2] Construction of New Research Buildings and Provision of Stable Research Space
- [1-3] Support for Research Activities and Achievements
- [1-5] Support for the Next Generation of Scholars
- [1-6] KU Grand Challenge Interdisciplinary Research Program
- [1-9] World-Class Scholar Recruitment Program
- [1-11] From International Collaborative Research Seed Funding to Large-Scale Global Research
- [1-12] AI-Based Research Infrastructure and KU AI-RG (Korea University AI-Research Grant)
- [4-3] Administrative Innovation in the Industry-Academic Cooperation Foundation



Q2. What will you do for Korea University in the age of AI?

AI is bringing fundamental changes to every aspect of the university, including research, education, and administration. Responding effectively to these changes requires not only efforts by individual departments and colleges but also a systematic approach that brings together the capabilities of the entire university. I will establish an AI Innovation Strategy Committee directly under the President to coordinate and implement Korea University's AI transformation in a comprehensive and consistent manner.

1. I will establish university-wide governance to lead AI innovation.

The AI Innovation Strategy Committee will serve as the university's central body responsible for coordinating AI-related policies and investments. It will connect innovation in research, education, and administration and ensure that university-wide resources are used efficiently.

- Develop a university-wide medium- and long-term AI strategy and establish investment priorities.
- Provide coordinated support for planning, budgeting, and technology adoption in AI-related initiatives.
- Improve investment efficiency by coordinating responsibilities across administrative units and developing shared infrastructure.
- Establish standards and ethical principles for the use of AI.

2. I will expand AI-based research infrastructure and establish a research funding system.

AI should not remain merely a subject of research in certain disciplines. It should become a shared resource that enhances research capabilities across all academic fields. I will provide both infrastructure and research funding so that researchers can use AI freely and pursue new research opportunities.

- Gradually develop shared AI computing clusters for faculty members and students.
- Expand research data management systems, research software, and professional AI research support staff.
- Introduce KU AI-RG (AI Research Grant) to support AI-related research across all academic disciplines.

3. I will establish a new direction for university education through the AI Education Innovation Center.

In the age of AI, independent thinking, sound judgment, and creative problem-solving are becoming more important than the acquisition of knowledge alone. The AI Education Innovation Center will coordinate a comprehensive response encompassing teaching methods, curricula, and educational infrastructure.

- Establish the AI Education Innovation Center and develop teaching and learning

methods suited to the AI era.
- Offer curricular and extracurricular programs that develop AI literacy and practical skills regardless of students' majors.
- Systematically manage educational AI tools and computing resources and ensure equitable access.

4. I will transform university administration using AI and digital technologies.

I will actively introduce AI technologies into repetitive and routine administrative tasks. This will improve administrative efficiency and allow staff members to focus on professional responsibilities such as planning, decision-making, and advising.
- Introduce AI, data analytics, and workflow automation technologies.
- Integrate administrative application, inquiry, and information services and expand the use of AI chatbots.
- Establish data-driven administration by connecting data across administrative units.

5. I will systematically support AI investments across colleges and campuses.

The AI Innovation Strategy Committee will coordinate support for AI-related investments undertaken by the College of Engineering, College of Informatics, Graduate School of Information Security, Korea University Medical Center, Sejong Campus, and other units.
- Support the establishment of an AI Semiconductor Convergence Research Institute in the College of Engineering.
- Support the development of an AI Computing Center at Korea University Medical Center.
- Support the expansion of AI research infrastructure at Sejong Campus.
- Provide coordinated support for university-wide AI investments and shared infrastructure.

AI innovation is a critical task that will determine Korea University's future competitiveness. I will bring together innovation in research, education, and administration with investments across colleges and campuses under a unified framework, enabling Korea University to become a leader in the age of AI.

Related Commitments:
- [1-12] AI-Based Research Infrastructure and KU AI-RG
- [2-4] AI Education Innovation Center
- [4-6] Future-Oriented Administration Based on AI and Digital Technologies
- [4-14] Establishment of the AI Innovation Strategy Committee
- Development Plans for the College of Engineering, College of Informatics, Graduate School of Information Security, Korea University Medical Center, Sejong Campus, and Other Units

Q3. What will you do for students?

Students are the reason universities exist and the foundation of their future. I will help students realize their potential without being held back by financial difficulties or institutional constraints, and ensure that they experience the joy of learning and growing at the university. To this end, I will pursue the following policies.

1. I will enable students to design their own majors and academic paths.

As students' interests and career goals become increasingly diverse, the university's academic system must become more flexible. I will improve academic policies so that students can freely pursue their interests and prepare for their futures.

- Lower barriers to double and multiple majors and expand student-designed and interdisciplinary majors.
- Improve course registration by expanding course offerings and educational resources in response to student demand.
- Announce course offerings and class schedules one semester in advance.
- Introduce AI academic coaches to provide personalized academic and career planning support.

2. I will provide education suited to the age of AI.

University education in the age of AI must go beyond transmitting knowledge to develop independent thinking, sound judgment, and problem-solving abilities. I will transform education so that students can use AI effectively while strengthening their ability to think for themselves.

- Establish the AI Education Innovation Center and develop new teaching and learning methods.
- Offer curricular and extracurricular programs that develop AI skills regardless of students' majors.
- Ensure equitable access to educational AI tools and computing resources.

3. I will reduce financial burdens and create a safe and comfortable living environment.

I will help students concentrate on their studies with fewer concerns about living expenses and housing. I will expand scholarship support and improve dormitories and student facilities.

- Expand scholarships beyond tuition assistance to include greater support for living expenses.
- Introduce a personalized scholarship notification system.
- Expand dormitory capacity and single-occupancy rooms, and improve access for

graduate students.
- Enhance housing safety through a certification system for boarding houses and studio apartments near campus.
- Expand spaces for student cultural activities, sports, and student organizations.

4. I will ensure that no student is left behind.

Differences in students' backgrounds, majors, and prior learning experiences should not lead to unequal educational opportunities. I will support all students, including those experiencing academic difficulties and international students, so that everyone can receive a high-quality education.

- Expand foundational learning support, tutoring, and academic counseling.
- Provide support at different stages of students' academic adjustment and development.
- Offer integrated support for international students from admission and academic study through campus life, graduation, and employment.

5. I will expand opportunities for students to enter professional life.

I will help students turn what they learn at the university into opportunities for new challenges and professional growth. In particular, I will draw on Korea University's strong alumni network and industry partnerships to expand practical work experience and employment opportunities.

- Expand internships and employment opportunities through alumni-owned and alumni-affiliated businesses.
- Support student entrepreneurship and expand practical training opportunities through startup companies.

I will make students' years at Korea University more meaningful and fulfilling. I will be a president who pays close attention to their needs, from small everyday inconveniences to major challenges that shape their futures.

Related Commitments:

- [2-3] Designing One's Own Major and Academic Path
- [2-4] AI Education Innovation Center
- [2-5] Education That Leaves No Student Behind
- [2-9] Support for Students' Financial and Living Needs
- [3-9] Idea to Venture: Turning Ideas into Global Businesses at Korea University
- [5-8] Strengthening Ties Between Alumni and Their Alma Mater

Q4. What will you do for university staff?

For Korea University to advance, the expertise and dedication of its staff must be respected, and staff members must be able to take pride in their work. I will build a university where staff members can develop their careers through fair opportunities, enjoy a healthy work-life balance, and actively participate in shaping the university's future.

1. I will establish a fair and predictable personnel system.

The efforts and expertise of staff members should be properly recognized. I will improve fairness and predictability in personnel management so that staff members can plan their careers and futures.

- Clarify evaluation criteria and principles governing promotion and administrative appointments.
- Replace uniform relative evaluations with assessments that reflect job characteristics, performance, and contributions.
- Establish appropriate staffing levels and assignments through medium- and long-term workforce planning.

2. I will strengthen staff expertise and expand opportunities to hold administrative leadership positions.

I will establish a system that enables staff members to develop professional expertise and advance their careers. Staff members with sufficient experience and capabilities will have greater opportunities to assume important roles in university administration.

- Establish specialized career tracks in major areas of university administration.
- Expand opportunities for professional training, extended study leave, graduate education in Korea and abroad, and benchmarking visits to overseas universities.
- Expand opportunities for staff members to serve in senior administrative positions, including (deputy) vice-presidential roles.
- Introduce a Senior Department Manager position and distinguish between position grades and functional responsibilities.

3. I will create a working environment that supports work-life balance.

I will help staff members fulfill their professional responsibilities while having sufficient time for rest and family life. Work-life balance is important not only for staff welfare but also for the university's competitiveness.

- Improve working arrangements, including concentrated university closure periods during vacations and flexible work schedules.
- Continuously review salaries, employee benefits, and working conditions.
- Create a working environment that improves both administrative efficiency and staff quality of life.

4. I will reduce unnecessary administrative work so that staff can focus on professional responsibilities.

I will reform outdated practices and unnecessary administrative procedures while actively adopting AI and digital technologies. The purpose of introducing AI is not to replace staff members but to enable them to focus on more valuable work.

- Launch an Administrative Capacity Task Force to eliminate duplicate tasks and unnecessary reporting and approval procedures.
- Reduce repetitive administrative work through AI and robotic process automation (RPA).
- Enable staff members to focus on professional responsibilities such as planning, decision-making, and advising.

5. I will foster a culture in which staff take ownership of university administration and pride in their work.

Staff members are not merely support personnel; they are essential contributors to the university's development. I will create a culture in which their views are reflected in university policies and they take an active role in administration.

- Regularly consult staff and other relevant members of the university community when introducing major administrative policies.
- Encourage administrative initiative, professional discretion, and creative problem-solving.
- Establish a compensation and recognition system that acknowledges dedication and contributions.

I will build a Korea University where staff members find fulfillment and pride in their work and can advance according to their efforts and abilities. Staff well-being and university development should go hand in hand.

Related Commitments:

- [4-1] Establishment of the Administrative Capacity Task Force
- [4-4] Participatory Administrative Decision-Making
- [4-6] Future-Oriented Administration Based on AI and Digital Technologies
- [4-5] A Culture of Administrative Initiative and Creativity
- [4-7] Working Environment Supporting Work-Life Balance
- [4-8] Staff Career Development and Specialized Career Tracks
- [4-9] Fair and Predictable Personnel Management
- [4-10] Expansion of Expertise-Based Administrative Appointments
- [4-13] Establishment of the Compliance Support Office
- [5-1] Compensation and Recognition for Dedication

Q5. What will you do for Korea University alumni?

Our alumni are a source of pride for Korea University and valued partners in its development. I will strengthen their ties with the university and help them take even greater pride in their alma mater. I will create a virtuous cycle in which alumni contribute their experience and expertise to the university's development, and the university's achievements, in turn, become a source of pride for its alumni.

1. I will enable alumni to participate directly in the university's development.

I will regard alumni not simply as donors but as partners in shaping the university's future. I will strengthen mechanisms for cooperation so that their extensive experience and wisdom can contribute to university governance.

- Establish a Korea University Development Advisory Council chaired by the President of the Alumni Association.
- Strengthen cooperation through reciprocal staff exchanges between the university and the Alumni Association.
- Establish an Alumni Information Center to facilitate networking, cooperation, and information sharing.

2. I will strengthen alumni ties with the university and actively support alumni activities.

I will ensure that Korea University remains a place of belonging and a source of pride for alumni long after graduation. I will strengthen communication between the university and the Alumni Association and support a wide range of alumni activities.

- Work with the Alumni Association to provide regular updates on university news and achievements.
- Support alumni use of university facilities, including Inchon Memorial Hall and university retreat facilities, for cultural and artistic activities.
- Promote networking and cooperation among alumni through the Alumni Information Center.

3. I will expand alumni networks and strengthen connections with current students.

I will ensure that Korea University's strong alumni network provides practical benefits to both alumni and current students. In particular, I will strengthen alumni connections at the department and college levels and support students as they prepare to enter professional life.

- Strengthen department-level alumni networks.
- Expand internships and employment opportunities for students through alumni-owned and alumni-affiliated businesses.

- Support information sharing and talent identification through the Alumni Information Center.

4. I will strengthen cooperation with alumni overseas.

I will help alumni around the world maintain lasting connections with their alma mater and participate in the development of Korea University as a global institution.

- Strengthen cooperation with overseas alumni associations, including the Federation of Korea University Alumni Associations in the Americas.
- Expand and regularize homecoming events for overseas alumni.
- Expand university fundraising through overseas alumni networks.

5. I will build a Korea University that alumni can take even greater pride in.

Alumni pride depends on the university's achievements and standing. I will strengthen the quality of education and research and develop Korea University into a world-leading institution so that alumni can take pride in their alma mater wherever they go.

- Strengthen university competitiveness through improvements in the quality of research and education.
- Expand partnerships with leading universities, businesses, and international organizations.
- Share university achievements with alumni and encourage their participation and contributions.

At Korea University, we have a saying: "Once you enter Korea University, you never truly graduate." I will preserve this tradition and build a university where alumni and their alma mater support one another and grow together.

Related Commitments:

- [3-3] Systematic Fundraising Support for Colleges and Departments
- [3-4] Expansion of Fundraising through Overseas Alumni Networks
- [3-5] Transformation of the Fundraising Paradigm
- [5-8] Strengthening Ties Between Alumni and Their Alma Mater

Q6. What are your plans for international students?

As the number of international students at Korea University has grown rapidly in recent years, our university has entered a new stage of internationalization. We must now move beyond increasing enrollment numbers to improving educational quality and providing systematic support from admission through academic study, campus life, graduation, and employment. I will create an environment where international students are not disadvantaged by language or cultural differences and can realize their full potential as valued members of the Korea University community.

1. I will provide integrated support from admission through graduation and employment.

I will improve our support system to address the various difficulties international students encounter throughout their university experience.

- Enhance the Global Service Center to provide integrated support for admission, immigration and relocation, academic study, graduation, and employment.
- Coordinate the administration of major-undecided admission programs for international students currently managed separately by the School of Liberal Studies, University College, and Division of International Studies.
- Strengthen support for international students in exploring majors and adjusting to academic life.

2. I will improve academic adjustment and educational quality for international students.

Differences in language proficiency and prior educational experiences should not result in unequal educational opportunities. I will provide support tailored to individual learning needs so that all students can receive a high-quality education.

- Provide support at different stages according to students' foundational academic skills and academic adjustment.
- Strengthen tutoring, academic counseling, and teaching assistant programs.
- Expand Korean-language education for international students in cooperation with the Korean Language Center.

3. I will reduce language and cultural barriers and create an inclusive campus.

I will ensure that international students can participate equally in all aspects of university life. I will foster a university community that respects language and cultural differences and encourages students from diverse backgrounds to interact naturally.

- Develop a campus environment that supports the use of AI-powered real-time interpretation.
- Remove institutional and practical barriers that prevent international students from participating in university activities.

4. I will ensure that international students' voices are reflected in university governance.

International students are important members of our university community. I will strengthen communication so that their opinions and needs are adequately reflected in university policies.

- Strengthen consultation with members of the university community who lack established representative organizations, including international students.
- Expand regular opportunities for communication between the university administration and students.
- Reflect international students' concerns about academic and campus life in university policy improvements.

The growing number of international students represents more than an increase in enrollment. It is an opportunity for Korea University to become a more diverse and international academic community. I will ensure that international students can learn and grow fully at Korea University and continue to take pride in their alma mater after graduation.

Related Commitments:

- [2-5] Education That Leaves No Student Behind
- [5-4] Regular Presidential Town Hall Meetings
- [5-5] Regular Communication with Representative Organizations
- [5-6] Strengthening Multicultural Inclusiveness



Q7. How will you attract and recruit outstanding faculty members?

1. I will expand departmental autonomy and improve faculty recruitment procedures.

The criteria for outstanding faculty members may differ across academic disciplines. I will move away from uniform research performance criteria and allow departments greater autonomy in recruiting the scholars they need. I will also make faculty recruitment more stable and predictable.

Specifically, I will distinguish between regular and special faculty allocations. Regular allocations will follow a recruitment-smoothing program that takes account of expected retirements over the next three to four years. Special allocations will be used to recruit faculty in emerging fields, strategic areas, and academic disciplines requiring institutional protection and support.

- Expand departmental autonomy and establish recruitment procedures that respect the characteristics of individual academic disciplines.
- Divide faculty position allocations into regular and special categories.
- Regular allocations: Introduce a recruitment-smoothing program based on expected faculty retirements over the next three to four years.
- Special allocations: Support recruitment in emerging fields, strategic areas, and disciplines requiring institutional protection.
- Strengthen startup support packages for newly appointed faculty, including initial research funding and research space.

2. I will actively recruit world-renowned scholars and outstanding researchers.

- Improve support programs for distinguished scholars.
- Introduce a World-Class Scholar Recruitment Program.
- Support the participation of internationally recognized industry experts in university research and education.
- Introduce the Seoktap Endowed Professorship.

Recruiting outstanding faculty requires more than hiring talented individuals. We must also provide an environment where they can pursue research with stability and continue to develop professionally. By improving faculty recruitment and research conditions together, I will make Korea University a place where outstanding scholars from around the world want to work, remain, and grow.

Related Commitments:

- [1-4] Faculty Recruitment Based on Departmental Autonomy

- [1-8] Improvement of Distinguished Scholar Support Programs
- [1-9] World-Class Scholar Recruitment Program
- [1-10] Expansion of Industry-Sponsored Chaired Professorships
- [1-13] Seoktap Endowed Professorship

IV. Strategic Directions

1. Be Ourselves — Restoring the University's Fundamental Mission

The fundamental mission of a university is education and research. Its most important role is to create new knowledge, expand the boundaries of human understanding, and use the knowledge and experience gained through research to educate future generations. Academic disciplines, from basic to advanced fields, must be free to develop. Faculty members should be able to devote themselves to research, and students should have opportunities to realize their full potential through quality education. All university policies and administrative systems should begin with the goal of supporting these essential activities.

Korea University has grown by overcoming numerous difficulties and challenges. Recent years have been no exception. Financial pressures resulting from a prolonged tuition freeze, rapidly changing educational demands, and changes in research and education brought about by AI are all reshaping the university's future. Yet, at every major turning point, Korea University has transformed crises into opportunities for progress and continued to lead society. This has been possible above all because of the academic capabilities of our faculty and the strength of our education.

The way to overcome today's challenges is not different. Sustainable development is possible when a university remains true to its fundamental mission and strengthens its own capabilities. Rather than treating university rankings or institutional size as goals in themselves, I will focus on building a university where excellent research and education take place and every member can fully realize their potential. As we strengthen our university from within, recognition and reputation will naturally follow. I will pursue growth and achievement that result from genuine academic strength, rather than expansion for its own sake. By reinforcing the university's fundamental mission, I will help Korea University become more fully itself.

First, I will strengthen the foundations of education and research.

A university's strength ultimately comes from faculty research and student education. I will provide the foundations for all faculty members to conduct research in a stable environment, including research endowment funds, basic research funding, and adequate research space. I will strengthen the quality of university education by developing students with fundamental knowledge and interdisciplinary thinking skills that remain valuable in the age of AI. I will also establish an open and flexible academic system that enables students to design their own majors and academic paths and responds to diverse educational needs. To help students concentrate on their studies without worrying about daily living expenses, I will expand financial support for living costs and increase dormitory capacity.

Related Commitments:
- [1-1] Establishment of College-Level Research Funds and Basic Research Funding
- [1-2] Construction of New Research Buildings and Provision of Stable Research Space
- [1-3] Support for Research Activities and Achievements
- [2-1] Humanistic Reflection and Understanding of Science and Technology
- [2-2] Deeper Knowledge in Majors, Broader Liberal Arts Education
- [2-3] Designing One's Own Major and Academic Path
- [2-4] AI Education Innovation Center
- [2-9] Support for Students' Financial and Living Needs, and Related Initiatives

Second, I will establish sound financial management to strengthen the university from within.

Sound finances are the foundation of sustainable university development. I will allocate and use limited resources more efficiently to strengthen the university's substantive competitiveness. I will continuously review the necessity and outcomes of university initiatives and ensure transparency in financial management. I will pursue financial policies that strengthen the university's foundations rather than merely support expansion in size.

Related Commitments:
- [3-1] Improving Budget Efficiency
- [3-2] Smart Resource Campus

Third, I will strengthen the university's competitiveness through professional administration and personnel management.

Administration is not merely a supporting function for education and research; it is an essential component of university competitiveness. I will establish an Administrative Capacity Task Force to develop a professional and accountable administrative system. I will also reform the administration of the Industry-Academic Cooperation Foundation so that researchers do not lose valuable research time to administrative procedures. In addition, I will establish a fair and predictable personnel system that properly recognizes staff members' abilities and achievements. I will create an environment where every member can fully exercise their capabilities and where the administrative organization itself becomes a driving force for university development.

Related Commitments:
- [4-1] Establishment of the Administrative Capacity Task Force
- [4-3] Administrative Innovation in the Industry-Academic Cooperation Foundation
- [4-5] A Culture of Administrative Initiative and Creativity
- [4-9] Fair and Predictable Personnel Management

Fourth, I will pursue genuine university development rather than evaluation for its own sake.

I will not treat external rankings and performance indicators as goals in themselves. Instead, I will properly assess the quality of our education and research and use the results as a guide to building a better Korea University. I will establish an evaluation system that enables members of the university community to take pride in their roles and contributions.

Related Commitments:
- [5-2] Establishment of a University Evaluation System That Inspires Pride

Fifth, I will recognize the dedication of our community, promote balanced development across campuses, and strengthen our ties with alumni.

The university's strength comes from the dedication of its members. I will establish a system that recognizes and rewards contributions, including those that may otherwise go unnoticed. I will ensure that the Seoul Campus, Sejong Campus, and Korea University hospitals grow together while developing their distinctive strengths. I will also preserve and strengthen the pride of our alumni, whose continued support is an essential part of Korea University's development.

Related Commitments:
- [5-1] Compensation and Recognition for Dedication
- [5-3] Campus and Hospital Specialization and Integrated Development Strategy
- [5-8] Strengthening Ties Between Alumni and Their Alma Mater

2. Thrive Together — Embracing Diversity in Harmony

A university is a community of people with diverse knowledge, ideas, and roles. Every academic discipline, from basic to advanced fields, is important and contributes to the development of the university and society in its own way. Faculty, staff, and students also play different roles within the university. No single set of values or standards can guide the development of an entire university. A university becomes stronger when different academic disciplines and members of its community are recognized for their distinctive characteristics and contributions and are able to grow together.

As Korea University has grown, it has pioneered new academic fields and developed diverse educational programs. Its members have also become increasingly diverse in nationality, gender, generation, and experience. With a broader range of academic disciplines, educational programs, and people, Korea University has grown into a larger and more diverse community. As a university grows and becomes more diverse, differences in opinions and interests naturally become more apparent. I will not regard these differences merely as sources of conflict. Instead, I will seek ways for us to recognize and respect our differences, communicate openly, and work together. Rather than applying uniform standards, I will respect the distinctive characteristics of academic disciplines and members of our community and build a university where autonomy, diversity, and creativity can flourish.

Diversity is not simply a value to be pursued for its own sake. It is a source of new opportunities for development. New research begins when different academic disciplines come together, and new possibilities emerge when people with different ideas and experiences communicate and collaborate. I will further expand diversity so that Korea University can embrace a broader world. At the same time, I will ensure that greater diversity leads to harmony and cooperation rather than division. By bringing together the wisdom and strengths of our entire community, I will build a Korea University that is stronger because of our differences and can go further because we work together.

First, I will ensure that different academic disciplines and members of our community are recognized for their distinctive characteristics and contributions.

I will not evaluate all academic disciplines and members of our community according to uniform standards. I will respect the characteristics of individual disciplines and departments, allowing them greater flexibility in recruiting the faculty they need. I will also support the next generation of scholars so that they can develop their academic careers in a stable environment. I will promote interdisciplinary research that brings different fields together and provide balanced support for research in the humanities and social sciences alongside science and engineering. I will also increase diversity among faculty members so

that different academic backgrounds and experiences become a new source of strength for the university.

Related Commitments:
- [1-4] Faculty Recruitment Based on Departmental Autonomy
- [1-5] Support for the Next Generation of Scholars
- [1-6] KU Grand Challenge Interdisciplinary Research Program
- [1-7] Establishment of a Research Coordination Center for the Humanities and Social Sciences, and Related Initiatives

Second, I will create an open educational environment that respects diverse learning needs and choices.

As students become more diverse in their backgrounds, interests, and career aspirations, university education must not remain confined to a single framework. I will ensure that every student, including those experiencing academic difficulties and international students, has access to quality education. I will foster a learning community where faculty and students ask questions and grow together. I will also improve faculty teaching obligations in a reasonable manner so that those who devote themselves to teaching are properly recognized.

Related Commitments:
- [2-5] Education That Leaves No Student Behind
- [2-6] Learning Together: Faculty and Students
- [2-7] A University That Recognizes Excellence in Teaching

Third, I will build a university where colleges, departments, and members of our community can develop autonomously and grow together.

As the university becomes more diverse, we must respect the distinctive characteristics, autonomy, and independence of individual colleges and departments rather than impose uniform methods and standards on every unit. I will support fundraising through department-level and overseas alumni networks so that colleges and departments can secure the resources they need for their own development. I will also establish a more autonomous administrative system centered on departments, where the university's core academic activities take place. Major administrative policies will be decided after carefully listening to the members of the university community who will be affected by them. I will ensure fair opportunities and work-life balance for staff members and build a university community where everyone respects one another and grows together.

Related Commitments:
- [3-3] Systematic Fundraising Support for Colleges and Departments
- [3-4] Expansion of Fundraising through Overseas Alumni Networks

- [4-2] Establishment of a Department-Centered Administrative System
- [4-4] Participatory Administrative Decision-Making
- [4-7] Working Environment Supporting Work-Life Balance
- [4-12] Expansion of Benefits at Korea University Hospitals, and Related Initiatives

Fourth, I will build a university community where respect and communication are part of everyday life.

I will create regular opportunities for communication between members of the university community and the central administration. I will listen carefully to different opinions, work to reconcile them, and ensure that the collective wisdom of our community is reflected in university governance. I will also ensure that international members of our community, regardless of language and cultural differences, can participate as equal members.

Related Commitments:
- [5-4] Regular Presidential Town Hall Meetings
- [5-5] Regular Communication with Representative Organizations
- [5-6] Strengthening Multicultural Inclusiveness

3. Soar Higher — Moving Beyond Our Limitations

Korea University has grown through constant challenges rather than settling for the status quo. Our efforts to remain true to the university's fundamental mission, strengthen our own capabilities, and foster respect and cooperation among different academic disciplines and members of our community are ultimately aimed at achieving greater progress. We will not be content merely to preserve what we have already accomplished. Building on our academic strengths and the power of diversity, we will continue to pursue higher goals.

New challenges always come with limitations. Financial resources may be insufficient, and administrative regulations may create obstacles. New research may require expensive equipment and facilities, while particularly ambitious research projects may struggle to secure sufficient funding through existing support systems. Innovative approaches to education and research may also be constrained by established rules and practices. We will not abandon new challenges because of these limitations. I will remove barriers to research and education and provide the resources and institutional support needed to turn the creative ambitions of our university community into reality.

University research goes beyond solving today's problems. It opens new possibilities for the future and offers ways to address challenges shared by humanity. I will encourage bold efforts to pioneer new academic fields, compete with the world's leading universities, and pursue research and education that have never been attempted before. I will make Korea University a place where research and education can change the world. By combining the capabilities we develop ourselves with the strengths we bring together as a community, we will build a Korea University that moves beyond its limitations and reaches new heights.

First, I will develop world-leading research capabilities.

To become one of the world's leading universities, we must not be satisfied with our current research capabilities. We must aim higher. I will actively recruit world-renowned scholars, expand opportunities for leading industry experts to participate in university research and education, and promote international collaborative research with outstanding researchers in Korea and abroad. I will also respond proactively to changes in the research environment brought about by AI, strengthening the foundations of research while opening new possibilities for discovery. My goal is to make Korea University a place where world-leading research can flourish.

Related Commitments:

- [1-8] Improvement of Distinguished Scholar Support Programs
- [1-9] World-Class Scholar Recruitment Program
- [1-10] Expansion of Industry-Sponsored Chaired Professorships
- [1-11] From International Collaborative Research Seed Funding to Large-Scale Global

Research

- [1-12] AI-Based Research Infrastructure and KU AI-RG
- [1-13] Seoktap Endowed Professorship

Second, I will open new possibilities through education that connects students with the world.

I will enable students to experience world-class education and research beyond the boundaries of Korea University. I will expand educational partnerships with leading universities around the world and connect Korea University's education more closely with the global academic community. I will support students in taking on ambitious challenges that push beyond their own limitations during their university years. By broadening their educational horizons, I will help them learn and grow on a global stage and prepare to lead a new era. I will also make Korea University's outstanding knowledge and educational resources more accessible to alumni, the public, businesses, and society.

Related Commitments:

- [2-8] Supporting Students' Great Challenges
- [2-10] A University Beyond Campuses and Borders
- [2-11] Education That Turns University Knowledge into a Resource for Society

Third, I will overcome financial constraints on university development by developing new sources of funding.

Limited financial resources are among the greatest obstacles to new initiatives. Rather than relying solely on traditional fundraising methods and tuition revenue, I will actively develop new sources of funding through businesses, alumni, and other revenue-generating opportunities. I will establish a sustainable financial foundation for education and research that supports the university's long-term development, ensuring that promising ideas and new initiatives are not abandoned because of financial constraints. I will also provide more systematic support for entrepreneurship among members of the university community and establish a framework in which entrepreneurs and the university share in the benefits of successful ventures.

Related Commitments:

- [3-5] Transformation of the Fundraising Paradigm
- [3-6] Establishment of a Long-Term University Endowment
- [3-7] Expansion of Corporate-Linked Fundraising
- [3-8] Diversification of Non-Tuition Revenue and Strengthening of Self-Financing Efforts
- [3-9] Idea to Venture: Turning Ideas into Global Businesses at Korea University

Fourth, I will transform university administration by overcoming outdated practices and institutional constraints.

We cannot respond to the rapidly changing university environment by relying solely on the rules and practices of the past. I will boldly reform unnecessary procedures and outdated practices while actively introducing AI, digital technologies, and new administrative systems. I will establish career development paths that allow staff members to strengthen their expertise and grow professionally, and expand opportunities for administrative appointments based on their qualifications and experience. I will also support initiatives from staff members that lead to administrative innovation, helping develop the next generation of university administrative leaders.

I will reorganize the Audit Office into a Compliance Support Office to establish a reliable legal protection and support system for members of the university community. In addition, I will establish an AI Innovation Strategy Committee directly under the President to systematically coordinate AI support and transformation across education, research, and administration.

Related Commitments:

- [4-6] Future-Oriented Administration Based on AI and Digital Technologies
- [4-8] Staff Career Development and Specialized Career Tracks
- [4-10] Expansion of Expertise-Based Administrative Appointments
- [4-11] Establishment of an Administrative Innovation Fund
- [4-13] Establishment of the Compliance Support Office
- [4-14] Establishment of the AI Innovation Strategy Committee

Fifth, I will build a world-class university through leadership based on dedication and respect.

I will develop a future-oriented, environmentally sustainable campus where every member of the university community can benefit from AI technologies and where we actively respond to the climate crisis. In doing so, I will strengthen Korea University's standing as an institution respected around the world. By bringing together the wisdom of our community, I will ensure that Korea University leads higher education in the age of AI and contributes to society through research and education.

Related Commitments:

- [5-7] Development of an Eco-Friendly Smart Campus
- [5-9] Leading Higher Education and Contributing to Society through Education and Research
- [5-10] Establishment of a Leadership Academy